

Quantum Mechanics II Excercise 1

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1 Natrual Units

1.1 Unit Equivilence

In CGS, the speed of light is measured in cm/sec . Therefore, for a unit system where $c = 1$, we get:

$$c = 3 \cdot 10^{10} cm/sec = 1 \quad (1)$$

$$1 sec = 3 \cdot 10^{10} cm \quad (2)$$

Therefore, distance and time are measured using the same units. Using the same logic, in CGS, mass is measured in grams and energy is measured in ergs. Assigning equation (2) into the definition of 1 erg, we get:

$$1 erg = 1 g \cdot \frac{cm^2}{sec^2} = 1 g \cdot \frac{cm^2}{9 \cdot 10^{20} cm^2} = \frac{1}{9} \cdot 10^{-20} g \quad (3)$$

And so we got that, assuming $c = 1$, the units for mass and energy are unified. This can also be shown using the relation from special relativity $E = mc^2$. As instructed, the units of mass and energy will be eV .

Now let's use the fact that $\hbar = 1$. $\hbar$ Has units of angular momentum. Angular momentum has units of $energy \times time$. Since $\hbar$ is unitless, this means that angular momentum is unitless, and requires the units of energy to be opposite to the unit of time:

$$\hbar = 10^{-27} erg \cdot sec = 1 \quad (4)$$

$$1 sec = 10^{27} erg^{-1} \quad (5)$$

Therefore the units of distance and time are opposite to the unit of energy and mass, and eV^{-1} can be used to measure them. Writing all of the units in eV is now just an issue of conversion from erg.

$$1 erg = 6.242 \cdot 10^{11} eV \quad (6)$$

$$1 g = 9 \cdot 10^{20} erg = 5.617 \cdot 10^{32} eV \quad (7)$$

$$1 sec = 10^{27} erg^{-1} = 1.6 \cdot 10^{15} eV^{-1} \quad (8)$$

$$1 cm = sec/(3 \cdot 10^{10}) = 5.34 \cdot 10^4 eV^{-1} \quad (9)$$

1.2 Newton's Constant and Plank Mass

Using the values from equations (6) to (9):

$$G_N = 6.7 \cdot 10^{-8} cm^3 sec^{-2} g^{-1} \quad (10)$$

$$G_N = 6.7 \cdot 10^{-8} \cdot (5.34 \cdot 10^4 eV^{-1})^3 \cdot (1.6 \cdot 10^{15} eV^{-1})^{-2} \cdot (5.617 \cdot 10^{32} eV)^{-1} \quad (11)$$

$$G_N = 7.095 \cdot 10^{-57} eV^{-2} \quad (12)$$

This is the very close to the value we would get using Plank Mass $M_{pl} = 1.2 \cdot 10^{19} GeV$:

$$G_N = M_{pl}^{-2} = (1.2 \cdot 10^{19} GeV)^{-2} = 6.94 \cdot 10^{-57} eV^{-2} \quad (13)$$

With a difference of around 2.1%, resulting probably from our rounding of the numbers.

1.3 The Actions of different systems

1.3.1 Tennis ball in a court

The average serve velocity is around $174 \text{ km/h} = 48.33 \text{ m/s}$ ¹. The length of a tennis court is 23.78 meters. Assuming the ball is being served horizontally, the time it would take to complete that distance is 0.492 seconds. In that time, the ball drops

$$\Delta y = \frac{1}{2}gt^2 = 1.18 \text{ m} \quad (14)$$

Assuming the pitch is done from an average height of 1.5 meters, we can ignore the floor. We will also ignore air resistance, even though it affects the motion, it will not make a visible change in the action relative to that of the water molecule. The speed of the ball is then, as a function of time:

$$\dot{x}^2 = v_0^2 + (gt)^2 = 2335.79 + 96.04t^2 \quad (15)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{1}{\hbar} S[x_c(t)] = \\ &= \frac{1}{\hbar} \int_0^{0.492 \text{ sec}} \frac{1}{2} 0.056 \text{ kg} \cdot (2335.79 + 96.04t^2) dt \sim 3.2 \cdot 10^{35} \end{aligned} \quad (16)$$

1.3.2 Water molecule in a teacup

The mean free path of a water molecule is roughly $2.5 \text{ \AA}^2$. During this time, the molecule moves in an average velocity depending on the temperature, following the formula

$$v = \sqrt{\frac{2k_B T}{m}} \quad (17)$$

Assuming the temperature of the tea is roughly 60°C and the mass of a water molecule is $3 \cdot 10^{-26} \text{ kg}$, we get an average speed of 553.75 m/s . This makes the mean free time $T = 4.5 \cdot 10^{-13}$ seconds. Assigning all of these into the action formule, we get:

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{1}{\hbar} S[x_c(t)] = \\ &= \frac{1}{\hbar} \int_0^{4.5 \cdot 10^{-13}} \frac{1}{2} 10^{-26} \text{ kg} \cdot (553.75 \text{ m/s})^2 dt \sim 21 \end{aligned} \quad (18)$$

2 Smeared Amplitude

¹<https://toomanyrackets.com/average-serve-speeds-in-tennis/>

²<https://galileo.phys.virginia.edu/classes/304/h2o.pdf>

3 Discrete version of the free scalar field

3.1 Commutation relations based on the Fourier modes

$$\begin{aligned}
[\phi_n, \phi_m] &= \left[\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k), \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{imp} \phi(p) \right] = \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(nk+mp)} [\phi(k), \phi(p)] = 0 \\
[\pi_n, \pi_m] &= \left[\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \pi(k), \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{imp} \pi(p) \right] = \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(nk+mp)} [\pi(k), \pi(p)] = 0 \\
[\phi_n, \pi_m] &= \left[\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k), \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{imp} \pi(p) \right] = \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(nk+mp)} [\phi(k), \pi(p)] = \\
&= \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(nk+mp)} i \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-il(k+p)} = \\
&= i \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(nk+mp)-il(k+p)} = \\
&= i \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{i(n-l)k} e^{i(m-l)p} = \\
&= i \sum_{l=-\infty}^{\infty} \delta_{nl} \delta_{ml} = i \delta_{nm}
\end{aligned} \tag{19}$$

3.2 The Hamiltonian based on the Fourier modes

$$\begin{aligned}
H &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\pi_n^2 + (\phi_{n+1} - \phi_n)^2 + m^2 \phi_n^2 \right] = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left[\left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \pi(k) \right)^2 + \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{i(n+1)k} \phi(k) - \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) \right)^2 + m^2 \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) \right)^2 \right]
\end{aligned} \tag{20}$$

The momentum dependent term of the Hamiltonian can be simplified using the substitution $p \rightarrow -p$ in the second integral, inverting the integration order and using the relations $\pi(-p) = \pi^\dagger(p)$ and $\sum_n e^{i(k-p)n} = 2\pi\delta(k-p)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
H_p &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \pi(k) \right)^2 = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{inp} \pi(p) \right) \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \pi(k) \right) = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{+\pi}^{-\pi} \frac{-dk}{2\pi} e^{-ink} \pi(-k) \right) \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{inp} \pi(p) \right) = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{-ink} \pi^\dagger(k) \right) \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{inp} \pi(p) \right) = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{-in(k-p)} \pi^\dagger(k) \pi(p) = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} \pi^\dagger(k) \pi(p) \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-in(k-p)} = \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} \pi^\dagger(k) \pi(p) 2\pi\delta(k-p) = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \pi^\dagger(k) \pi(k)
\end{aligned} \tag{21}$$

The term of the restoring force follows the exact same logic:

$$\frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} m^2 \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) \right)^2 = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} m^2 \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(k) \quad (22)$$

And the interaction term is

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{i(n+1)k} \phi(k) - \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) \right)^2 = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) (e^{ik} - 1) \right)^2 = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} e^{ink} \phi(k) (e^{ik} - 1) \right) \left(\int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{inp} \phi(p) (e^{ip} - 1) \right) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dp}{2\pi} e^{-in(k-p)} \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(p) (e^{-ik} - 1) (e^{ip} - 1) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(k) (e^{-ik} - 1) (e^{ik} - 1) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(k) (2 - 2 \cos(k)) = \end{aligned} \quad (23)$$

Putting it all together we get

$$\begin{aligned} H &= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} [\pi^\dagger(k) \pi(k) + (m^2 + 2(1 - \cos(k))) \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(k)] = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} [\pi^\dagger(k) \pi(k) + \omega_k^2 \phi^\dagger(k) \phi(k)] \end{aligned} \quad (24)$$

With the dispersion relation

$$\omega_k = \sqrt{m^2 + 2(1 - \cos(k))} \quad (25)$$

With the lattice spacing Δ , it becomes

$$\omega_k = \sqrt{m^2 + \frac{2}{\Delta^2} (1 - \cos(k\Delta))} \quad (26)$$

And at the limit $k\Delta \ll 1$ we get

$$\frac{2}{\Delta^2} (1 - \cos(k\Delta)) = \frac{2}{\Delta^2} \left[1 - \left(1 - \frac{(k\Delta)^2}{2} \right) \right] = \frac{(k\Delta)^2}{\Delta^2} = k^2 \quad (27)$$

Which is the Klein-Gordon dispersion relation from Special Relativity:

$$\omega_k = \sqrt{m^2 + k^2} \quad (28)$$

3.3 Ladder Operators

$$a_k = \frac{1}{\sqrt{4\pi\omega_k}} (\omega_k \phi(k) + i\pi(k)), \quad a_k^\dagger = \frac{1}{\sqrt{4\pi\omega_k}} (\omega_k \phi^\dagger(k) - i\pi^\dagger(k)) \quad (29)$$

The commutation relations are

$$\begin{aligned}
[a_k, a_p] &= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\phi(k) + i\pi(k), \omega_p\phi(p) + i\pi(p)] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\omega_p[\phi(k), \phi(p)] + i(\omega_k[\phi(k), \pi(p)] + \omega_p[\pi(k), \phi(p)]) - [\pi(k), \pi(p)]] = \\
&= -\frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} \left(\omega_k \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-in(k+p)} - \omega_p \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-in(k+p)} \right) = \\
&= -\frac{\omega_k - \omega_p}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} 2\pi\delta(k+p) = 0
\end{aligned} \tag{30}$$

Where in the last part the delta function forced $k = -p$, in which case $\omega_k = \omega_p$ since ω is invariant to the sign of k . From this commutation relations the commutation relations $[a_k^\dagger, a_p^\dagger]$ are obvious to develop using the relations $\phi^\dagger(k) = \phi(-k)$ and $\pi^\dagger(k) = \pi(-k)$, and a variable substitution back $k \rightarrow -k'$ and $p \rightarrow -p'$:

$$\begin{aligned}
[a_k^\dagger, a_p^\dagger] &= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\phi^\dagger(k) - i\pi^\dagger(k), \omega_p\phi^\dagger(p) - i\pi^\dagger(p)] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\phi(-k) - i\pi(-k), \omega_p\phi(-p) - i\pi(-p)] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_{-k'}\omega_{-p'}}} [\omega_{-k'}\phi(k') - i\pi(k'), \omega_{-p'}\phi(p') - i\pi(p')] = \\
&= \frac{\omega_{-k'} - \omega_{-p'}}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_{-k'}\omega_{-p'}}} 2\pi\delta(k' + p') = 0
\end{aligned} \tag{31}$$

Where we again used the fact that $\omega_k = \omega_{-k}$, this time to show that if $p' = k'$ then $\omega_{-p'} = \omega_{p'} = \omega_k$. The last commutation relation we want to check is $[a_k, a_p^\dagger]$:

$$\begin{aligned}
[a_k, a_p^\dagger] &= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\phi(k) + i\pi(k), \omega_p\phi^\dagger(p) - i\pi^\dagger(p)] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_p}} [\omega_k\phi(k) + i\pi(k), \omega_p\phi(-p) - i\pi(-p)] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_{-p'}}} [\omega_k\phi(k) + i\pi(k), \omega_{-p'}\phi(p') - i\pi(p')] = \\
&= \frac{1}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_{-p'}}} (-i\omega_k [\phi(k), \pi(p')] + i\omega_{-p'} [\pi(k), \phi(p')]) = \\
&= \frac{\omega_k + \omega_{-p'}}{4\pi\sqrt{\omega_k\omega_{-p'}}} 2\pi\delta(k+p') = \delta(k+p') = \delta(k-p)
\end{aligned} \tag{32}$$

Where in the last line, the only case when the delta function is not zero is the case where the fraction evaluates to one.

The Hamiltonian is then:

$$H = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-\pi}^{+\pi} \frac{dk}{2\pi} [\pi^\dagger(k)\pi(k) + \omega_k^2\phi^\dagger(k)\phi(k)] \tag{33}$$